# FEDERAL SYSTEM

**FEDERAL TEST, FORMATION AND → FEDERAL FEATURES AND UNION → LEGISLATIVE DISTRIBUTION AND CONFLICT → PARLIAMENT ENTERING THE STATE → ADMINISTRATIVE RELATIONS → FINANCIAL DISTRIBUTION AND FISCAL**

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure: the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

★ PRIMARY CORE FLOW ● SUBORDINATE EXTRA ◆ APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g8 and all prior artifacts unchanged

00

## STAGE 00 FEDERAL TEST, FORMATION AND TERRITORY

FEDERAL TEST, FORMATION AND TERRITORY | FEDERAL TEST | CONSTITUTION PROTECTS UNION AND STATE AUTHORITY IN ASSIGNED SPHERES | INDIAN FORMATION | ARTICLE 1 | UNION OF STATES; HOLDING-TOGETHER, UNION-WEIGHTED DESIGN | ARTICLE 3 | PRESIDENTIAL RECOMMENDATION + STATE VIEWS, NOT STATE CONSENT

### CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- FEDERAL TEST
- Constitution protects Union and State authority in assigned spheres both levels act directly on citizens
- neither is an ordinary delegate one sovereign constitutional order

### POWER / PROCEDURE

- no unilateral State secession
- INDIAN FORMATION
- Article 1: Union of States; holding-together, Union-weighted design

### CHECK / LIMIT

- Article 3: presidential recommendation + State views, not State consent
- Article 4: reorganisation law is not an Article 368 amendment
- MUST REMEMBER: Test federalism through dual government, constitutional distribution, supremacy, rigidity, independent courts and bicameral representation.

### FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- then map the Union tilt through Articles 3, 248-253, 256-257, 312, 352-356 and integrated constitutional institutions.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Indian federalism distributes not only law-making subjects but also.**

01

## STAGE 01 FEDERAL FEATURES AND UNION BIAS

FEDERAL FEATURES AND UNION BIAS | FEDERAL FEATURES DUAL POLITY + WRITTEN SUPREME CONSTITUTION + | UNION BIAS RESIDUARY POWER + STATE-FIELD EXCEPTIONS + EMERGENCIES | CONSTITUTIONALLY FEDERAL AND UNION-WEIGHTED; NOT UNITARY IN SPIRIT.

FEDERAL FEATURES dual polity + written supreme Constitution + Seventh Schedule selective rigidity + independent → UNION BIAS residuary power + State-field exceptions + emergencies integrated services + single citizenship + → VERDICT: constitutionally federal and Union-weighted, not unitary in spirit.

### CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- FEDERAL FEATURES dual polity + written supreme Constitution + Seventh Schedule selective rigidity + independent judiciary + Rajya Sabha
- UNION BIAS residuary power + State-field exceptions + emergencies integrated services + single citizenship + greater fiscal capacity

### POWER / PROCEDURE

- VERDICT: constitutionally federal and Union-weighted, not unitary in spirit.
- FEDERAL FEATURES dual polity + written supreme Constitution + Seventh Schedule selective rigidity + independent judiciary + Rajya Sabha

### CHECK / LIMIT

- UNION BIAS residuary power + State-field exceptions + emergencies integrated services + single citizenship + greater fiscal capacity
- VERDICT: constitutionally federal and Union-weighted, not unitary in spirit.

### FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- FEDERAL FEATURES dual polity + written supreme Constitution + Seventh Schedule selective rigidity + independent judiciary + Rajya Sabha
- UNION BIAS residuary power + State-field exceptions + emergencies integrated services + single citizenship + greater fiscal capacity

**MECHANISM / VERDICT —** VERDICT: constitutionally federal and Union-weighted, not unitary in spirit.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: constitutionally federal and Union-weighted, not unitary in spirit.**

02

## STAGE 02 LEGISLATIVE DISTRIBUTION AND CONFLICT

LEGISLATIVE DISTRIBUTION AND CONFLICT | ARTICLES 245-246 | TERRITORIAL REACH + THREE-LIST ALLOCATION | UNION 100 | STATE 61 | CONCURRENT 52 | STANDARD EXAM COUNTS | GST COMPETENCE

ARTICLES 245-246: territorial reach + three-List allocation

Union 100 → State 61 → Concurrent 52: standard exam counts

### CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- ARTICLES 245-246: territorial reach + three-List allocation
- Union 100

### POWER / PROCEDURE

- State 61
- Concurrent 52: standard exam counts

### CHECK / LIMIT

- 246A: GST competence
- 248 + Entry 97: parliamentary residuary power

### FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- CONFLICT METHOD pith and substance → true nature harmonious construction → reconcile overlap
- Article 254 → Concurrent conflict only; assent may save State law locally

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Article 254 → Concurrent conflict only; assent may save State law locally.**

03

## STAGE 03 PARLIAMENT ENTERING THE STATE FIELD

PARLIAMENT ENTERING THE STATE FIELD | STATE-FIELD DOORS | RAJYA SABHA, TWO-THIRDS PRESENT/VOTING, NATIONAL INTEREST | ARTICLE 352 EMERGENCY; LAW SURVIVES SIX MONTHS AFTER IT | TWO OR MORE STATES REQUEST; PARLIAMENT CONTROLS AMENDMENT/REPEAL | TREATY IMPLEMENTATION; STILL SUBJECT TO THE CONSTITUTION | AFFECTED STATE DURING PRESIDENT'S RULE; S.R. BOMMAI (1994) REVIEW | NO GENERAL UNION POWER TO LEGISLATE ON LIST II.

### CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- STATE-FIELD DOORS
- 249: Rajya Sabha, two-thirds present/voting, national interest

### POWER / PROCEDURE

- 250: Article 352 Emergency; law survives six months after it ends
- 252: two or more States request; Parliament controls amendment/repeal

### CHECK / LIMIT

- 253: treaty implementation; still subject to the Constitution
- 356-357: affected State during President's Rule; S.R. Bommai (1994) review

### FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- TRAP: no general Union power to legislate on List II.
- STATE-FIELD DOORS

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: no general Union power to legislate on List II.**

04

## STAGE 04 ADMINISTRATIVE RELATIONS

ADMINISTRATIVE RELATIONS | ARTICLES 256-257 SECURE COMPLIANCE AND PREVENT IMPEDANCE OF UNION | RECIPROCAL DELEGATION | UNION FUNCTIONS | STATE WITH CONSENT | STATE FUNCTIONS | UNION WITH UNION CONSENT | 261 FULL FAITH/CREDIT

### CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- ARTICLES 256-257 secure compliance and prevent impedance of Union executive power directions are text-bounded, not a general administrative takeover
- RECIPROCAL DELEGATION

### POWER / PROCEDURE

- 258: Union functions → State with consent
- 258A: State functions → Union with Union consent

### CHECK / LIMIT

- 261 full faith/credit
- 262 water-dispute law

### FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- 263 Inter-State Council
- ARTICLES 256-257 secure compliance and prevent impedance of Union executive power directions are text-bounded, not a general administrative takeover

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: 261 full faith/credit | 262 water-dispute law | 263 Inter-State Council.**

05

## STAGE 05 FINANCIAL DISTRIBUTION AND FISCAL AUTONOMY

FINANCIAL DISTRIBUTION AND FISCAL AUTONOMY | FISCAL CONSTITUTION | LEVY, COLLECTION, ASSIGNMENT AND IGST APPORTIONMENT | DIVISIBLE POOL | 275 AND 282 | DISTINCT GRANT ROUTES | FINANCE COMMISSION REPORT | CONDITIONAL BORROWING CONSENT

FISCAL CONSTITUTION → 268/269/269A: levy, collection, assignment and IGST apportionment → 270: divisible pool → 275 and 282: distinct grant routes → 280-281: Finance Commission report

### CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- FISCAL CONSTITUTION
- 268/269/269A: levy, collection, assignment and IGST apportionment
- 270: divisible pool
- 275 and 282: distinct grant routes

### POWER / PROCEDURE

- 280-281: Finance Commission report
- 293: conditional borrowing consent
- 16TH FINANCE COMMISSION report submitted 17 Nov 2025
- award 2026-31

### CHECK / LIMIT

- States: 41% vertical share; exact horizontal weights need official report
- CLOSE DISTINCTION: Article 1's 'Union of States' rejects a secession compact but does not make
- India unitary.
- Federalism is basic structure

### FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- the Union may be stronger and States territorially alterable while each level retains constitutionally assigned fields.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: India unitary. Federalism is basic structure; the Union may be stronger and States territorially alterable while each level retains constitutionally assigned fields.**

06

## STAGE 06 BASIC STRUCTURE AND EMERGENCY CONTROL

BASIC STRUCTURE AND EMERGENCY CONTROL | CASE CHAIN | WEST BENGAL (1962) | NO SOVEREIGN-STATE COMPACT | KESAVANANDA BHARATI (1973) | LIMITED AMENDMENT POWER | S.R. BOMMAI (1994) | FEDERALISM BASIC STRUCTURE; ARTICLE 356 REVIEW

CASE CHAIN

West Bengal (1962): no sovereign-State compact → Kesavananda Bharati (1973): limited amendment power → S.R. Bommai (1994): federalism Basic Structure; Article 356 review

### CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- CASE CHAIN
- West Bengal (1962): no sovereign-State compact

### POWER / PROCEDURE

- Kesavananda Bharati (1973): limited amendment power
- S.R. Bommai (1994): federalism Basic Structure; Article 356 review

### CHECK / LIMIT

- DUTY != REMEDY.
- Article 355: protect States and ensure constitutional government

### FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- Articles 356-357: exceptional remedy + legislative consequence disputed majority ordinarily belongs on the House floor
- State of Rajasthan v. Union of India (1977): cautious pre-S.R. Bommai (1994) review

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: State of Rajasthan v. Union of India (1977): cautious pre-S.R. Bommai (1994) review.**

07

## STAGE 07 WORKING MODES AND SHARED-RULE INSTITUTIONS

WORKING MODES AND SHARED-RULE INSTITUTIONS | MODES COEXIST COOPERATIVE | GST, TRANSFERS, DISASTER COORDINATION COMPETITIVE | INVESTMENT, INNOVATION, OUTCOME IMPROVEMENT BARGAINING | PARTIES, SCHEMES, FISCAL NEGOTIATION CONFRONTATIONAL | ASSENT, CBI, WATER, TAX AND BORROWING DISPUTES | RAJYA SABHA + ISC + ZONAL COUNCILS + GST | HEALTH TEST

### CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- MODES COEXIST cooperative: GST, transfers, disaster coordination competitive: investment, innovation, outcome improvement bargaining
- parties, schemes, fiscal negotiation confrontational: assent, CBI, water, tax and borrowing disputes

### POWER / PROCEDURE

- CHANNELS: Rajya Sabha + ISC + Zonal Councils + GST Council + FC + courts
- HEALTH TEST: conflict becomes reasons, negotiation and adjudication.

### CHECK / LIMIT

- Mohit Minerals (2022): GST Council advice is non-binding
- 2024 West Bengal ruling (2024 INSC 502): Article 131 suit survived preliminary objections; CBI-consent merits were not decided.

### FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- MODES COEXIST cooperative: GST, transfers, disaster coordination competitive: investment, innovation, outcome improvement bargaining
- parties, schemes, fiscal negotiation confrontational: assent, CBI, water, tax and borrowing disputes

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: 2024 West Bengal ruling (2024 INSC 502): Article 131 suit survived preliminary objections; CBI-consent merits were not decided.**

08

## STAGE 08 ASYMMETRIC FEDERALISM

ASYMMETRIC FEDERALISM | DIFFERENTIATED CONSTITUTIONAL ACCOMMODATION | FIFTH SCHEDULE | SCHEDULED AREAS + GOVERNOR/TAC SAFEGUARDS | SIXTH SCHEDULE | TRIBAL AREAS IN FOUR STATES + AUTONOMOUS COUNCILS | ARTICLE 371 FAMILY + DIFFERENTIATED UNION-TERRITORY ARRANGEMENTS | ARTICLE 239AA ILLUSTRATES A DISTINCT CAPITAL-TERRITORY DESIGN

### CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- ASYMMETRY = DIFFERENTIATED CONSTITUTIONAL ACCOMMODATION
- Fifth Schedule: Scheduled Areas + Governor/TAC safeguards

### POWER / PROCEDURE

- Sixth Schedule: tribal areas in four States + autonomous councils
- Article 371 family + differentiated Union-Territory arrangements

### CHECK / LIMIT

- Article 239AA illustrates a distinct capital-territory design
- LIMIT: common citizenship continues; asymmetry is not arbitrary inequality.

### FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- ASYMMETRY = DIFFERENTIATED CONSTITUTIONAL ACCOMMODATION
- Fifth Schedule: Scheduled Areas + Governor/TAC safeguards

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LIMIT: common citizenship continues; asymmetry is not arbitrary inequality.**

09

## STAGE 09 REPRESENTATION AND CURRENT CONTROLS

REPRESENTATION AND CURRENT CONTROLS | RAJYA SABHA GIVES UNEQUAL STATE REPRESENTATION; LOK SABHA TRACKS | 131ST BILL | NEGATIVED 17 APR 2026, 298-230; PROPOSED 850 IS NOT | CENSUS CONDUCT/REFERENCE DATES | PUBLICATION OR DELIMITATION DATES | CURRENT FRICTION | GOVERNOR ASSENT

Rajya Sabha gives unequal State representation; Lok Sabha tracks population → 131st Bill: negatived 17 Apr 2026, 298-230; proposed 850 is not law → Census conduct/reference dates != publication or delimitation dates → CURRENT FRICTION → Governor assent: no fixed timeline/deemed assent; prolonged silence reviewable

### CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- Rajya Sabha gives unequal State representation; Lok Sabha tracks population
- 131st Bill: negatived 17 Apr 2026, 298-230; proposed 850 is not law

### POWER / PROCEDURE

- Census conduct/reference dates != publication or delimitation dates
- CURRENT FRICTION

### CHECK / LIMIT

- Governor assent: no fixed timeline/deemed assent; prolonged silence reviewable
- CBI: State consent rule; constitutional-court exception

### FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- Rajya Sabha gives unequal State representation; Lok Sabha tracks population
- 131st Bill: negatived 17 Apr 2026, 298-230; proposed 850 is not law

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Governor assent: no fixed timeline/deemed assent; prolonged silence reviewable.**

10

## STAGE 10 VERIFIED PYQS AND PRELIMS TRAPS

VERIFIED PYQS AND PRELIMS TRAPS | TEN ROUTES | MODES + CENTRALISING LAWS | CBI + FEDERAL ESSENCE | PARTY INCENTIVES | ARTICLE 356 + GST + PRISONS | CENTRE-STATE TRUST | FISCAL FEDERALISM

TEN ROUTES

2020: modes + centralising laws → 2021: CBI + federal essence → 2022: party incentives

### CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- TEN ROUTES
- 2020: modes + centralising laws
- 2021: CBI + federal essence

### POWER / PROCEDURE

- 2022: party incentives
- 2023: Article 356 + GST + prisons
- 2024: Centre-State trust

### CHECK / LIMIT

- 2025: fiscal federalism
- Article 254 is Concurrent-specific
- 262 exclusion needs parliamentary law

### FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- Article 355 is not automatic 356
- GST recommendations are non-binding
- State competence is autonomous, not sovereign

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Article 355 is not automatic 356 | GST recommendations are non-binding.**

11

## STAGE 11 MARKS-SCALED ANSWER SPINE

MARKS-SCALED ANSWER SPINE | 10 MARKS | ONE ARTICLE CLUSTER | ONE CASE | 15 MARKS | ADD MECHANISMS | NAMED EVIDENCE | SPECIFIC REFORM

10 MARKS: define → one Article cluster → one case → qualified verdict → 15 MARKS: add mechanisms → named evidence → counterpoint → specific reform → 20 MARKS: integrate asymmetry + representation + current control → graded verdict → MASTER SPINE definition → allocation → administration/finance → operation → evidence → limitation → reform → conclusion

### CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- 10 MARKS: define → one Article cluster → one case → qualified verdict
- 15 MARKS: add mechanisms → named evidence → counterpoint → specific reform
- 20 MARKS: integrate asymmetry + representation + current control → graded verdict

### POWER / PROCEDURE

- MASTER SPINE definition → allocation → administration/finance → operation → evidence
- limitation → reform → conclusion
- VERDICT: Union capacity earns federal legitimacy through consultation and restraint.

### CHECK / LIMIT

- LEGAL/SOURCE LIMIT: Current federal claims must distinguish enacted law, advisory judgments and
- failed proposals: the 2025 Article 143 opinion controls assent, the 16th Finance
- Commission retains 41 percent vertical devolution, and the defeated 131st Amendment Bill,

### FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- 2026 never amended the Constitution.

**MECHANISM / VERDICT —** VERDICT: Union capacity earns federal legitimacy through consultation and restraint.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Union capacity earns federal legitimacy through consultation and restraint.**

E

## EXTRA SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT | 14. ADVANCED CLASSIFICATIONS AND SCHOLARS - OPTIONAL | [ANALYSIS] THE 2022 GS-II PROPOSITION IS BROADLY PLAUSIBLE AS | NATIONAL PARTIES CONTROLLING THE UNION MAY PREFER UNIFORMITY AND | COUNTEREVIDENCE MATTERS | NATIONAL PARTIES DEMAND AUTONOMY WHEN IN STATE OPPOSITION | REGIONAL PARTIES CAN CENTRALISE WITHIN THEIR STATES | COALITION GOVERNMENTS LED BY NATIONAL PARTIES STRENGTHENED STATE BARGAINING.

### OPTIONAL DOCTRINE / CASE

- 14. Advanced classifications and scholars - optional
- [ANALYSIS] The 2022 GS-II proposition is broadly plausible as an incentive pattern, not an ideological law.
- National parties controlling the Union may prefer uniformity and central leverage; regional parties may seek fiscal and administrative autonomy.
- Counterevidence matters: national parties demand autonomy when in State opposition

### ADVANCED LIMIT

- regional parties can centralise within their States
- coalition governments led by national parties strengthened State bargaining.
- Best verdict: institutional location and electoral incentives often explain federal preference better than party label alone .
- Advanced classifications and scholars - optional Scholar toolkit | Scholar / label | Use | Limit | |---|---|---| | K.C.

### COMPARATIVE NUANCE

- Political federalism: party competition, coalition arithmetic and regional parties can decentralise or centralise actual power without textual amendment.
- Executive federalism: much coordination occurs among executives and officials, which can improve speed but weaken legislative transparency.
- Multi-level federalism: local governments complicate a simple Union-State binary even though Parts IX and IX-A do not create co-equal sovereign units.
- Dialogic federalism: councils, commissions, courts and elections create repeated exchanges rather than one final allocation of every dispute.

**OPTIONAL STATUS —** This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels